

# Julius Zhang

Ph.D. Student in Computer Science  
Courant Institute of Mathematical Sciences, New York University

Email [julius.z@nyu.edu](mailto:julius.z@nyu.edu) (primary)  
[hz3183@columbia.edu](mailto:hz3183@columbia.edu)  
Website [jui3s.github.io](https://jui3s.github.io)  
GitHub [github.com/Jul3s](https://github.com/Jul3s)

## EXPERIENCE

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### Columbia University

*Visiting Researcher*

Jun. 2026 - Present

- Conduct research in the Department of Mathematics, hosted by Andrew Blumberg.

### a16z

*Researcher*

Apr. 2025 - Jul. 2026

- Research on new cryptographic constructions from lattice-based cryptography and commitment compression techniques.
- Building [Jolt](#), open-source zero-knowledge virtual machine in Rust. Implemented and benchmarked [torus compression](#), yielding a  $3\times$  reduction in commitment size; proved optimality with a conceptual reframing via Hilbert 90. Performance engineering across the proving stack, including sum-check optimization.
- Audited proof systems security: verify correctness of [elliptic-curve optimizations](#) and formalize folklore results into rigorous [proofs](#).
- Evaluated lattice-based cryptography parameters against known attacks under various security regimes and performance constraints.

### Millennium

*Quantitative Researcher*

Jun. 2024 - Apr. 2025

- Applied methods in convex optimization and robust statistical estimation to real-time trading systems. Inference from partial and noisy data.

### Stellar Development Foundation

*Consultant*

Jun. 2023 - Sept. 2023

- Byzantine fault tolerance, C++, [stellar-core](#).
- Improved maximum transaction rate per second by 17% via changes to the consensus protocol, reducing number of communication rounds in overlay network. Formal verification in TLA+.

### Distributed Systems and TCS Research, Stanford University

*Researcher*

Sept. 2022 - Jun. 2024

- Under David Mazières, research in general open membership Byzantine fault tolerance protocols ([Github](#)), with applications to certificate authority management and automatic password recovery with hardware security modules.
- Research PCP under Aviad Rubinfeld, reconstructed proof of the 2-to-2 Games Conjecture. Proved a result about Convex Continuous Class Complexity.

### Topology Research, Stanford University

*Researcher*

Jul. 2020 - May 2022

- Floer homotopy theory under Mohammed Abouzaid; related the complex cobordism Gysin map to the Grothendieck residue symbol and derived a recursive formula for Gromov–Witten quantum product corrections.
- Research under Ciprian Manolescu. Floer theory, Seiberg–Witten, knot invariants. Produced new potential counterexamples for the smooth Poincaré conjecture.

## SELECTED PAPERS AND MANUSCRIPTS

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- Zachary DeStefano, Noah Golub, Zile Huang, **Julius Zhang**, Sam Frank, and Michael Walfish  
*Spain: Succinct Proofs for Numerical Computations*.  
USENIX Symposium on Operating Systems Design and Implementation (OSDI), 2026.  
[\[Paper\]](#) [\[Code\]](#)
- Julius Zhang.  
*The Relative Trace-Zero Subgroup of the Barreto-Naehrig Curves*.  
Cryptology ePrint Archive, 2026.  
[\[Paper\]](#)
- Julius Zhang.  
*Complex Cobordism and Formal Group Law*.  
Stanford University, 2024.  
[\[Paper\]](#)

## TALKS

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- *p-Ordinary Cohomology for  $SL(2)$  over Number Fields.*  
Hida Theory Seminar, Columbia University, 2026.
- *Construction of Seiberg-Witten-Floer stable homotopy types.*  
Homotopy Theory and Manifolds Seminar, Columbia University, 2026.
- *Bordered Heegaard Floer Homology and the Surgery Exact Triangle.*  
Stanford University, 2022.
- *Knots, links, and the search for exotic 4-spheres.*  
Stanford University, 2021.

## EDUCATION

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### **Courant Institute of Mathematical Sciences, New York University**

*Ph.D. in Computer Science*

June 2026 - Present

### **Stanford University**

*M.S. in Computer Science; B.A. in Mathematics*

Sept. 2019 - Jun. 2024

General Wang Yaowu Scholarship.

## SKILLS

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**Computer Science.** Rust, C/C++, Python; optimization and robust estimation; high-performance numerical systems; cryptography and verifiable computation; formal verification.

**Mathematics.** Number theory, algebraic geometry, homotopy theory.